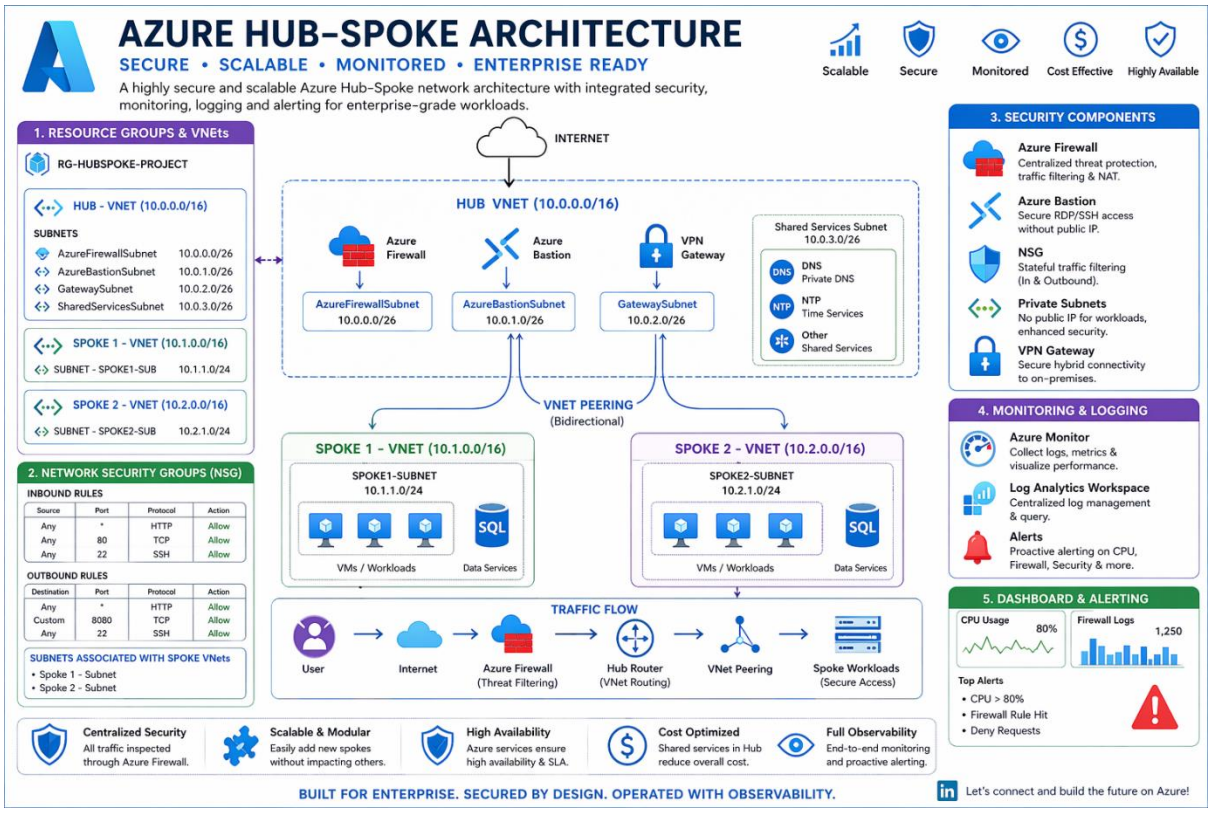
Azure Hub-Spoke Network Architecture with Security, Grafana Dashboards, Monitoring & Smart Alerts Implementation

Architecture Diagram:

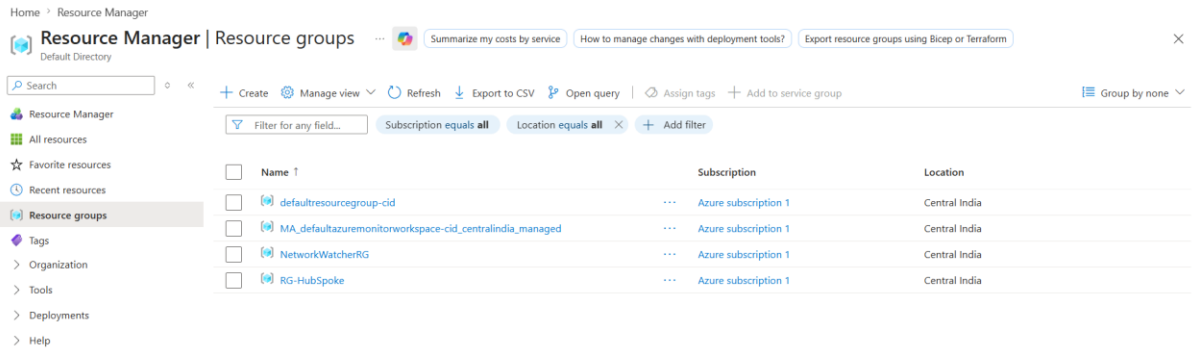


Work Flow Diagram:

Implementation Steps

Step 1: Create Resource Groups

- **RG-Hubspoke-Project** – Central India



Step 2: Create VNets

Create | Manage view | Refresh | Export to CSV | Open query | ··· | Group by none

Filter for any field...

Subscription equals **all** | Resource Group equals **all** | Location equals **all** | Add filter

Name ↑	Resource Group	Location	Subscription
HUB-Vnet	RG-HubSpoke	Central India	Azure subscripti...
Spoke1-Vnet	RG-HubSpoke	Central India	Azure subscripti...
Spoke2-Vnet	RG-HubSpoke	Central India	Azure subscripti...

Hub-VNet

- Region: Central India
- Address Space: **10.0.0.0/16**

Subnets:

- AzureFirewallSubnet → **10.0.0.0/26**
  Range: **10.0.0.0 – 10.0.0.63**
- AzureBastionSubnet → **10.0.1.0/24**
  Range: **10.0.1.0 – 10.0.1.255**

Create subnets to segment the virtual network address space into smaller ranges for use by your applications. When you deploy resources into a subnet, Azure assigns the resource an IP address from the subnet.

Search subnets

Name ↑	IPv4	IPv6	Available IPs	Delegated to	Security gro
AzureFirew...	10.0.0.0/26	-	56	-	-
AzureBasti...	10.0.1.0/24	-	249	-	-

Spoke1-VNet

- Region: Central India
- Address Space: **10.1.0.0/16**

Subnet:

- spoke1-sub → **10.1.1.0/24**

Spoke2-VNet

- Region: Central India
- Address Space: **10.2.0.0/16**

Subnet:

- spoke2-sub → **10.2.1.0/24**

Step 3: Peerings

Hub ↔ Spoke1

- Allow VNet access
- Allow forwarded traffic

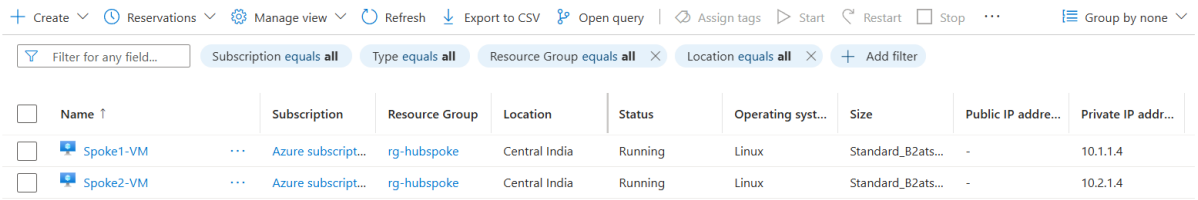
Hub ↔ Spoke2

- Allow VNet access
- Allow forwarded traffic

Spoke1 ↔ Spoke2

- Allow VNet access
- Allow forwarded traffic

Step 4: Create Spoke VMs



Name	Subscription	Resource Group	Location	Status	Operating syst...	Size	Public IP addre...	Private IP addr...
Spoke1-VM	Azure subscript...	rg-hubspoke	Central India	Running	Linux	Standard_B2ats...	-	10.1.1.4
Spoke2-VM	Azure subscript...	rg-hubspoke	Central India	Running	Linux	Standard_B2ats...	-	10.2.1.4

Spoke1-VM

- Region: Central India
- Ubuntu Image
- Connect V-Net to networking

Public IP:

- Enable temporarily for installing software
- Then remove Public IP

Spoke2-VM

- Region: Central India
- Ubuntu Image
- Connect V-Net to networking

Public IP:

- Enable temporarily for installing software
- Then remove Public IP

Step 5: Add Security

5.1 Deploy Azure Firewall

- Click **Firewall** → **Create**

Basic Tab

- **RG:** RG-HubSpoke-Project
- **Name:** FW-Hub
- **Region:** Same
- **Firewall SKU:** Standard
- **Virtual Network:** Select Use Existing
- **Public IP:** Create New
- **Name:** FW-publicIP

Click **OK** → **Review + Create**

Go to Firewall Rules

- Click **Add Rule Collections**
- Select **Network Rules**

+ Add Delete

tule collections are sets of rules of the same type, DNAT, network, or application rules. Rule collection groups can include ule collections of various types.

Name	Type	Priority	Rules	Inherited from
DefaultNetwork...	Rule collection group	200	4	
Allow-Internal	- No rules -	100	0	
Allow-Internet	Network rule collecti...	101	1	
Allow-HTTP	Network rule collecti...	102	1	
RT	Network rule collecti...	104	1	
TR	Network rule collecti...	105	1	
TEMP	- No rules -	106	0	
DefaultDnatRule...	Rule collection group	100	1	
DNAT-HTTP	DNAT rule collection	100	1	

Internal Rule

- **Name:** Allow-Internal
- **Type:** Network
- **Priority:** 104
- **Action:** Allow
- **Group:** Default Network Rule Collection Group

Name	Type	Source	Protocol	Port	Destination Type	Destination
Allow-Internet	IP	10.1.1.4	TCP	80,443	IP	*

HTTP Rule

- **Name:** Allow-HTTP
- **Type:** Network
- **Priority:** 102
- **Action:** Allow
- **Group:** Default Network Rule Collection Group

Name	Type	Source	Protocol	Port	Destination Type	Destination
Allow-HTTP	IP	*	TCP	80	IP	*

Proxy Server

Rule Details

- **Name:** RT
- **Type:** Network

- **Priority:** 104
- **Action:** Allow
- **Group:** Default Network Rule Collection Group

Name	Type	Source	Protocol	Ports	Destination Type	Destination
RT	IP	10.1.0.0/16	TCP	8080	IP	10.2.0.0/16

Reverse Rule

Name	Type	Source	Protocol	Ports	Destination Type	Destination
TR	IP	10.2.0.0/16	Any	*	IP	10.1.0.0/16

DNAT Rule

- **Name:** DNAT-HTTP
- **Type:** DNAT
- **Priority:** 100
- **Action:** Allow
- **Group:** Default DNAT Rule Collection Group

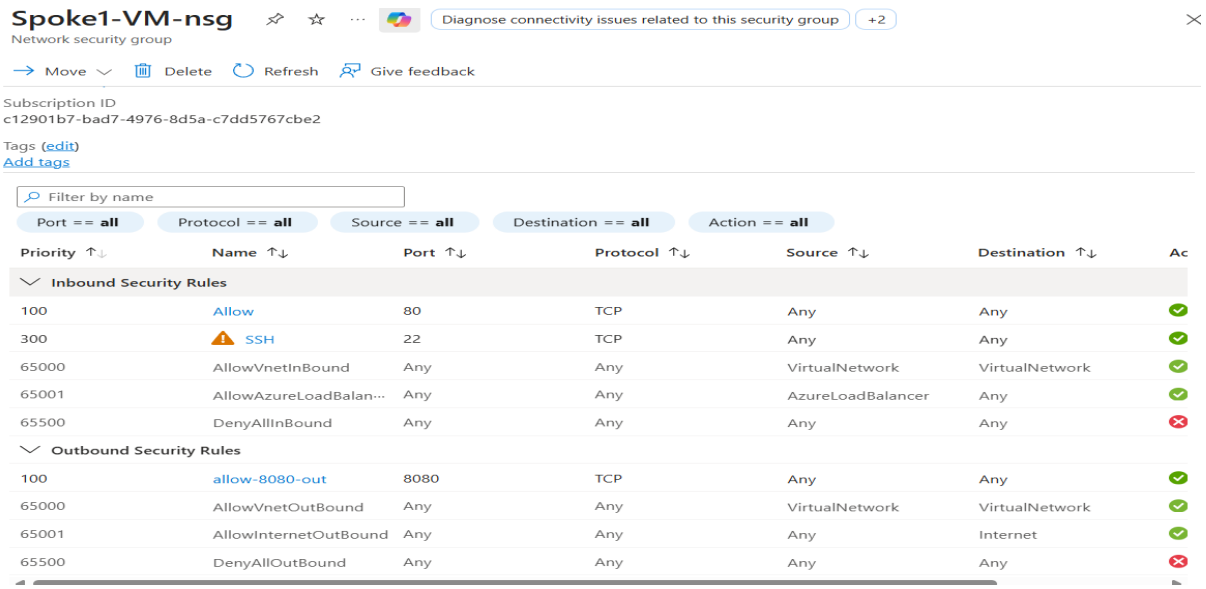
Name	Type	Source	Protocol	Ports	Destination Firewall IP
DNAT-HTTP	IP	*	TCP	80	74.225.233.159

Translation

Translated Type	Address	Port
IP	10.1.1.4	80

Step 5.2: Network Security Group

Create Spoke1 NSG (or already created)



Add Inbound Rules

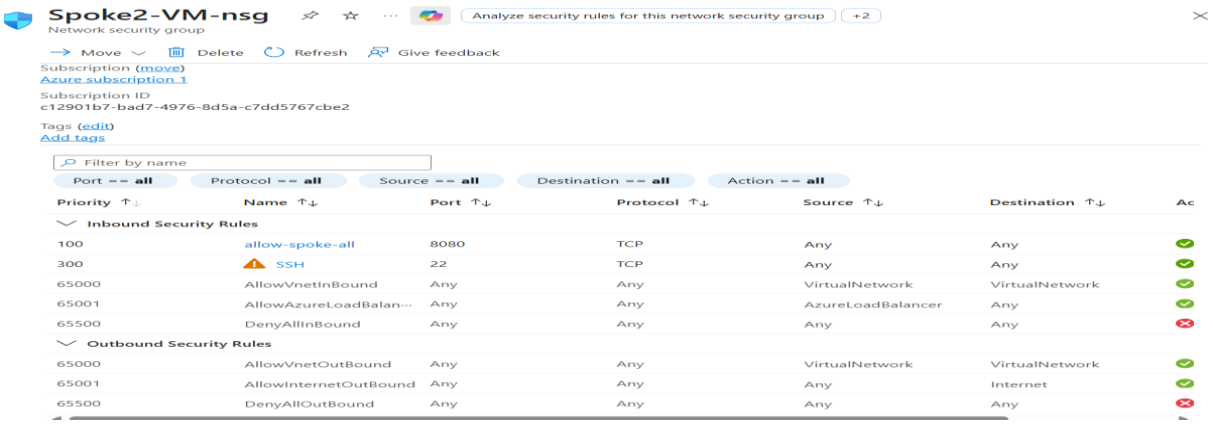
Source	Port	Destination	Service	Range	Protocol	Action
Any	*	Any	HTTP	80	TCP	Allow
Any	*	Any	SSH	22	TCP	Allow

Add Outbound Rule

Source	Port	Destination	Service	Port No	Protocol	Action
Any	*	Any	Custom	8080	TCP	Allow

Subnet (Important) : Associate with **Spoke1-Subnet**

Create Spoke2 NSG (or already created)



Add Inbound Rules

Source	Port	Destination	Service	Range	Protocol	Action
Any	*	Any	Custom	8080	TCP	Allow
Any	*	Any	SSH	22	TCP	Allow

Subnet (Important)

Associate with **Spoke2-Subnet**

Step 6: Create Bastion

Create

- **Name:** Bastion-Hub
- **RG:** RG-HubSpoke-Project
- **Region:** Central India
- **Virtual Network:** Hub-VNet
- **Subnet:** AzureBastionSubnet
- **Public IP:** Create New → Bastion-PIP
- **SKU:** Standard

Click **Review + Create**

Step 7: Install Software in Both Spokes

Use **MobaXterm** login with **Spoke1-VM**

Install NGINX in Spoke1

```
sudo su
apt update
apt install nginx -y
```

Install Tomcat in Spoke2

ssh mokesh@10.2.1.4:8080
login
apt update
apt install default-jdk -y
apt install tomcat10

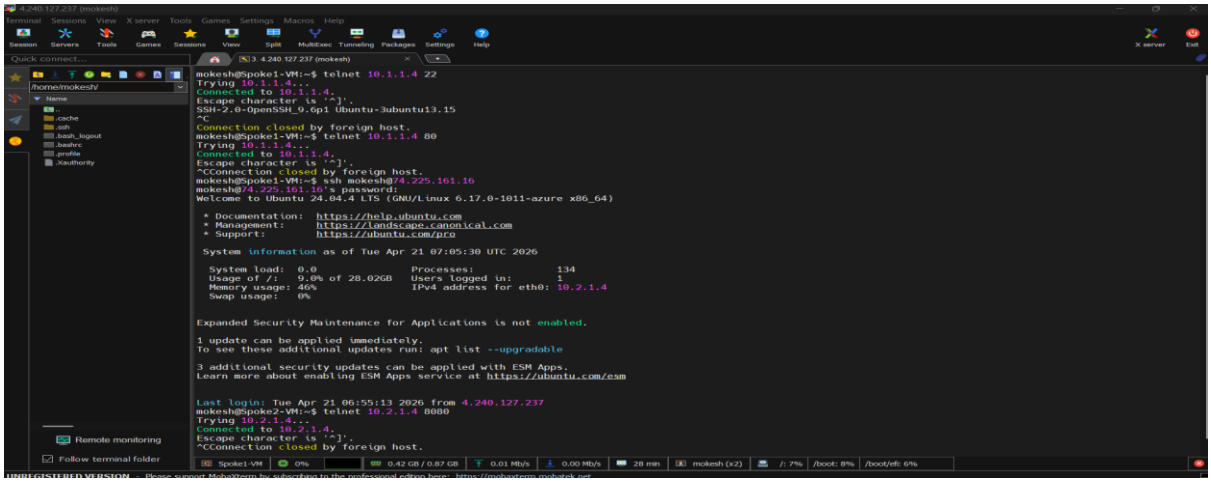
Test Connectivity

- Test connection on **22** and **8080** ports.
- When successfully connected:

1. First remove IP configuration from **Spoke1**
2. Then delete the Public IP

Important: Do not delete Public IP directly.

3. Repeat the same process for **Spoke2** also.



Step 8: Login Bastion → Spoke1-VM

Connect to VM

ssh username@spoke1-private-ip

Update System

sudo apt update -y
sudo apt upgrade -y

Network Connectivity Check

ip a
ping -c 4 8.8.8.8

Install Web Server

apt install nginx -y

Start & Enable NGINX

sudo systemctl start nginx
sudo systemctl enable nginx
sudo systemctl status nginx

```
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ sudo systemctl status nginx
● nginx.service - A high performance web server and a reverse proxy server
     Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/nginx.service; enabled; preset: enabled)
     Active: active (running) since Tue 2026-04-21 15:09:59 UTC; 24h ago
       Docs: man:nginx(8)
   Main PID: 17286 (nginx)
      Tasks: 3 (limit: 1035)
     Memory: 5.1M (peak: 5.7M)
        CPU: 1.946s
     CGroup: /system.slice/nginx.service
             ├─17286 "nginx: master process /usr/sbin/nginx -g daemon on; master_process on;"
             ├─17287 "nginx: worker process"
             └─17288 "nginx: worker process"
```

Check Service Locally

curl http://localhost

Output: HTML code

```
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ curl http://localhost
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="ISO-8859-1"?>
<!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.0 Strict//EN"
  "http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml1/DTD/xhtml1-strict.dtd">
<html xmlns="http://www.w3.org/1999/xhtml" xml:lang="en" lang="en">
<head>
    <title>Apache Tomcat</title>
</head>

<body>
<h1>It works !</h1>

<p>If you're seeing this page via a web browser, it means you've setup Tomcat successfully. Congratulations!</p>

<p>This is the default Tomcat home page. It can be found on the local filesystem at: <code>/var/lib/tomcat10/webapps/ROOT/index.html</code></p>

<p>Tomcat veterans might be pleased to learn that this system instance of Tomcat is installed with <code>CATALINA_HOME</code> in <code>/usr/share/tomcat10</cc
</p> and <code>CATALINA_BASE</code> in <code>/var/lib/tomcat10</code>, following the rules from <code>/usr/share/doc/tomcat10-common/RUNNING.txt.gz</code>.</p>

<p>You might consider installing the following packages, if you haven't already done so:</p>

<p><b>tomcat10-docs</b>: This package installs a web application that allows to browse the Tomcat 10 documentation locally. Once installed, you can access it
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<p>NOTE: For security reasons, using the manager webapp is restricted to users with role "manager-gui". The host-manager webapp is restricted to users with ro
le "admin-gui". Users are defined in <code>/etc/tomcat10/tomcat-users.xml</code>.</p>

</body>
</html>
```

Check Port Listening

sudo ss -tulnp | grep 80

Output: Listen :80 user: nginx

```
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ sudo ss -tulnp | grep 80
tcp   LISTEN 0      511            0.0.0.0:80        0.0.0.0:*    users:(("nginx",pid=17288,fd=5),("nginx",pid=17287,fd=5),("nginx",pid=17286,fd=5))
tcp   LISTEN 0      4096   [::ffff:127.0.0.1]:4317        *:*    users:(("MetricsExtensio",pid=18880,fd=13))
tcp   LISTEN 0      4096   [::ffff:127.0.0.1]:4316        *:*    users:(("MetricsExtensio",pid=18880,fd=10))
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$
```

Firewall Check

sudo ufw status

Output: Active

```
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ sudo ufw status
Status: active

To                         Action      From
--                         ------      ----
22/tcp                     ALLOW       Anywhere
80                         ALLOW       Anywhere
22/tcp (v6)                ALLOW       Anywhere (v6)
80 (v6)                    ALLOW       Anywhere (v6)
```

Final Command (Run in Spoke1)

curl http://10.2.1.4:8080

Output: HTML page with Tomcat information

```
okesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ curl http://10.2.1.4:8080
?xml version="1.0" encoding="ISO-8859-1"?>
!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.0 Strict//EN"
  "http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml1/DTD/xhtml1-strict.dtd">
html xmlns="http://www.w3.org/1999/xhtml" xml:lang="en" lang="en">
head>
   <title>Apache Tomcat</title>
/head>

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e "admin-gui". Users are defined in <code>/etc/tomcat10/tomcat-users.xml</code>.</p>

/body>
/html>
okesh@Spoke1-VM:~$
```

Login Into Bastion Through Spoke2-VM

Connect VM

ssh username@spoke2-private-ip

Update System

sudo apt update -y
sudo apt upgrade -y

Install Java

sudo apt install tomcat -y
tomcat -version

```
mokesh@Spoke2-VM:~$ sudo apt install tomcat10 -y
Reading package lists... Done
Building dependency tree... Done
Reading state information... Done
tomcat10 is already the newest version (10.1.16-1).
0 upgraded, 0 newly installed, 0 to remove and 1 not upgraded.
```

Check Running Application

ps -ef | grep java

```
okesh@Spoke2-VM:~$ ps -ef | grep tomcat10
omcat      4994       1  0 Apr21 ?        00:02:31 /usr/lib/jvm/default-java/bin/java -Djava.util.logging.config.file=/var/lib/tomcat10/conf/logging.properti
es -Djava.util.logging.manager=org.apache.juli.ClassLoaderLogManager -Djava.awt.headless=true -Djdk.tls.ephemeralDHKeySize=2048 -Djava.protocol.handler.pkgs=o
rg.apache.catalina.webresources -Dorg.apache.catalina.security.SecurityListener.UMASK=0027 --add-opens=java.base/java.lang=ALL-UNNAMED --add-opens=java.base/j
ava.io=ALL-UNNAMED --add-opens=java.base/java.util=ALL-UNNAMED --add-opens=java.base/java.util.concurrent=ALL-UNNAMED --add-opens=java.rmi/sun.rmi.transport=A
LL-UNNAMED -classpath /usr/share/tomcat10/bin/bootstrap.jar:/usr/share/tomcat10/bin/tomcat-juli.jar -Dcatalina.base=/var/lib/tomcat10 -Dcatalina.home=/usr/sha
re/tomcat10 -Djava.io.tmpdir=/tmp org.apache.catalina.startup.Bootstrap start
okesh     27699   27534  0 15:51 pts/0    00:00:00 grep --color=auto tomcat10
```

Check Application Port

sudo ss -tulnp | grep 8080

Output: Listen *:8080 user: java

```
mokesh@Spoke2-VM:~$ sudo ss -tulnp | grep 8080
tcp   LISTEN 0      100                *:8080            *:*    users:(("java",pid=4994,fd=38))
mokesh@Spoke2-VM:~$
```

Test Backend Locally

curl http://localhost:8080

Output: HTML file

```
mokesh@Spoke2-VM:~$ curl http://localhost:8080
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="ISO-8859-1"?>
<!DOCTYPE html PUBLIC "-//W3C//DTD XHTML 1.0 Strict//EN"
  "http://www.w3.org/TR/xhtml1/DTD/xhtml1-strict.dtd">
<html xmlns="http://www.w3.org/1999/xhtml" xml:lang="en" lang="en">
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</body>
</html>
mokesh@Spoke2-VM:~$
```
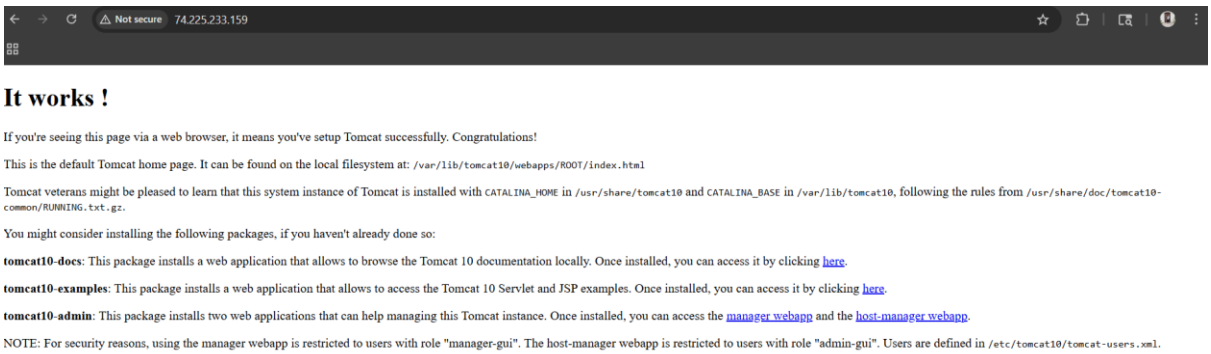

Final Output

Run this in Chrome or any browser:

http://74.225.233.159



Step 9: Monitoring Using Azure Monitor + Log Analytics

Create Log Analytics Workspace

- **Name:** LAW-HubSpoke
- **RG:** RG-HubSpoke-Project
- **Region:** Central India

Click **Review + Create**

Step 9.1 Install / Enable Azure Monitor Agent on Linux VMs

Attached **Azure Monitor Agent (AMA)** to:

- Spoke1-VM (Linux)
- Spoke2-VM (Linux)

Used for:

✅ Performance metrics collection
✅ Syslog / system logs
✅ VM health monitoring
✅ Alert rule integration
✅ Log Analytics data ingestion

Azure Portal Path:

Virtual Machine → Monitoring → Insights / Monitoring → Enable

or

VM → Extensions + Applications

You may see:

- Azure Monitor Linux Agent
  or
- Azure Monitor Agent(Windows)

AzureMonitorLinuxAgent

Type
Microsoft.Azure.Monitor.AzureMonitorLinuxAgent

Version
1.41.0

Status
Provisioning succeeded

Status level
Info

Status message
Plugin enabled

Handler status
Ready

Handler status level
Info

Automatic upgrade status
Enabled

Step 9.2

Go to **Spoke1-VM**

- Open **Monitor**
- Enable **Enhanced Monitoring**
- Configure and Enable

Repeat the same steps in **Spoke2-VM** also.

Step 9.3: Connect Azure Firewall Logs

Open:

Firewall → FW-Hub → Monitoring → Diagnostic Settings

Add Diagnostic Setting

- **Name:** FW-Logs

Select Logs

- Application Rule Log ✓
- Network Rule Log ✓
- DNS Proxy Log ✓

Destination

- Send to **Log Analytics Workspace** ✓

Select:

- **LAW-HubSpoke**

Click **Save**

Step 9.4: Alert

Open:

VM → Monitor → Azure Monitor

Create **Alert**

Create Alert Scope

Select Resource:

- **RG-HubSpoke-Project**
- **Location:** Central India

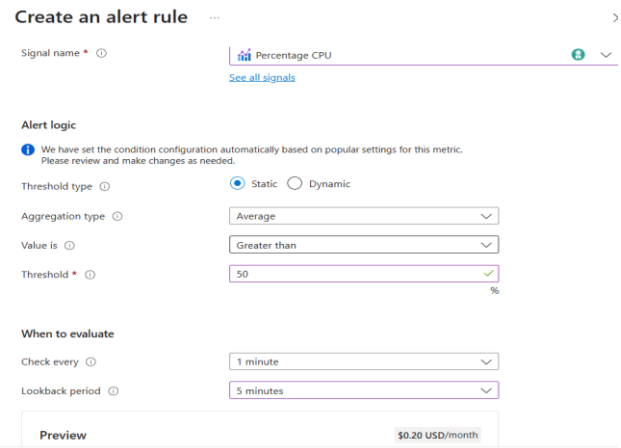
Refine Scope

Type Location

VM Central India

Click **Apply**

Condition



- **Signal Name:** Percentage CPU

Alert Logic

- **Threshold:** Static
- **Aggregation:** Average
- **Operator:** Greater Than
- **Threshold Value:** 50%

When to Evaluate

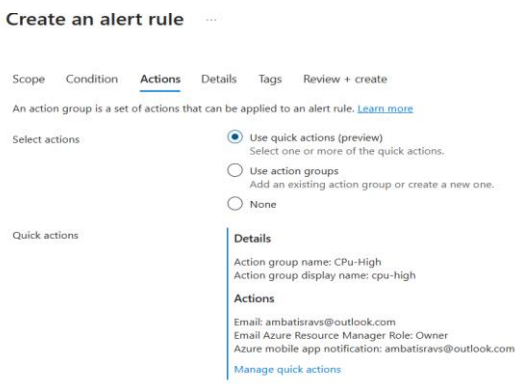
- Check every: **1 minute**
- Lookback period: **5 minutes**

Action

Select Action:

- Use quick actions

Details



- **Name:** CPU
- **Alert Name:** CPU-High
- **Email:** ---
- **Role:** Owner
- **Notification:** ---

Click **Save**

Details

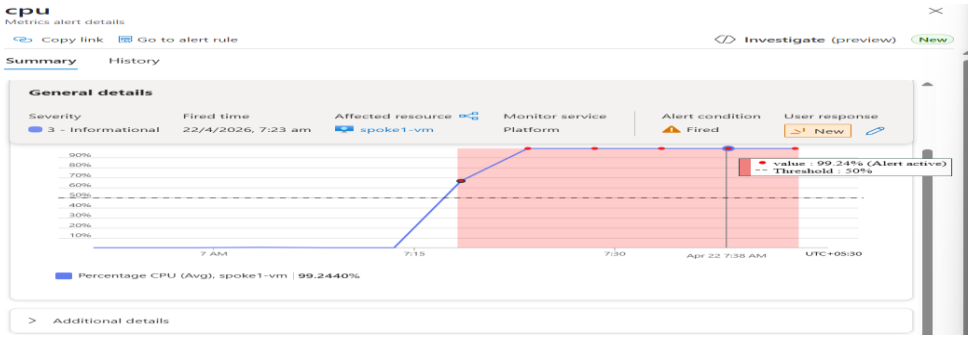
- **Alert Rule Name:** CPU-High

Click **Review + Create**

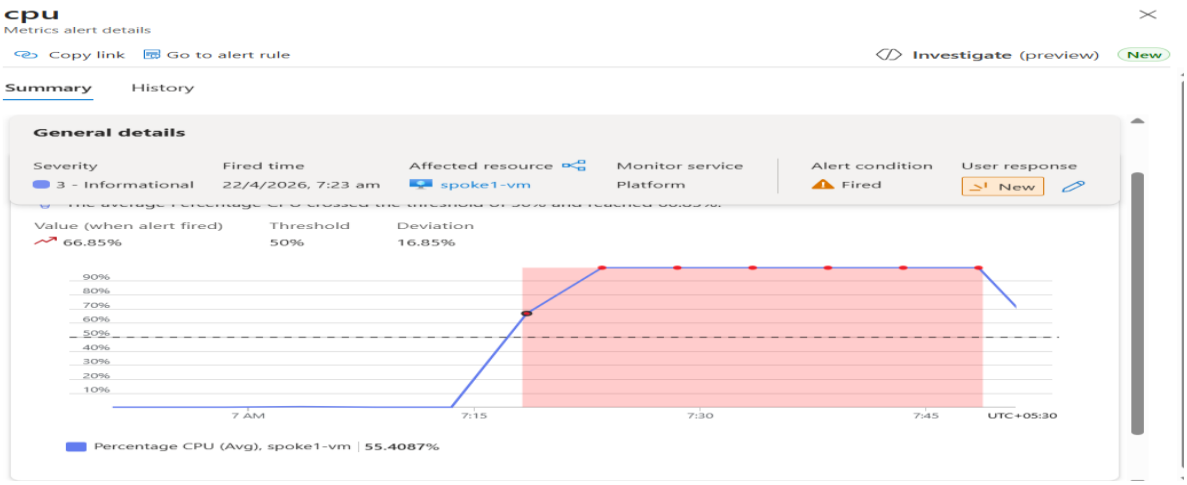
Azure Monitor Alert Rule

From docs:

- CPU alert when threshold exceeded
- Email notification configured



When Remove the CPU Workload



When CPU goes above **50%**, you receive an **email alert**

Microsoft Azure

Fired:Sev3 Azure Monitor Alert cpu on spoke1-vm (microsoft.compute/virtualmachines) at 4/22/2026 1:53:01 AM

Investigate with agent >

View the alert in Azure Monitor >

Summary

Alert name	cpu
Severity	Sev3
Monitor condition	Fired
Affected resource	spoke1-vm
Resource type	microsoft.compute/virtualmachines
Resource group	rg-hubspoke
Monitoring service	Platform
Signal type	Metric
Fired time	April 22, 2026 1:53 UTC
Alert ID	79e1b383-eb19-4bbe-9f65-ac51ac72f000

Alert rule ID	https://portal.azure.com/#resource/subscriptions/c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7dd5767cbe2/resourceGroups/RG-HubSpoke/providers/microsoft.insights/metricAlerts/cpu

Metric alert condition type	MultipleResourceMultipleMetricCriteria
Time aggregation	Average
Metric name	Percentage CPU
Metric namespace	microsoft.compute/virtualmachines
Metric value	66.853
Operator	GreaterThan
Threshold	50

Another Alert for Firewall

Create scope same as first alert.

Refine Scope

Type	Region
Firewall	Central

Condition

- **Signal:** Custom Log Search

Click **Add Query**

```
AzureDiagnostics
| where Category == "AzureFirewallNetworkRule"
| where msg_s contains "Deny"
```

Continue editing alert.

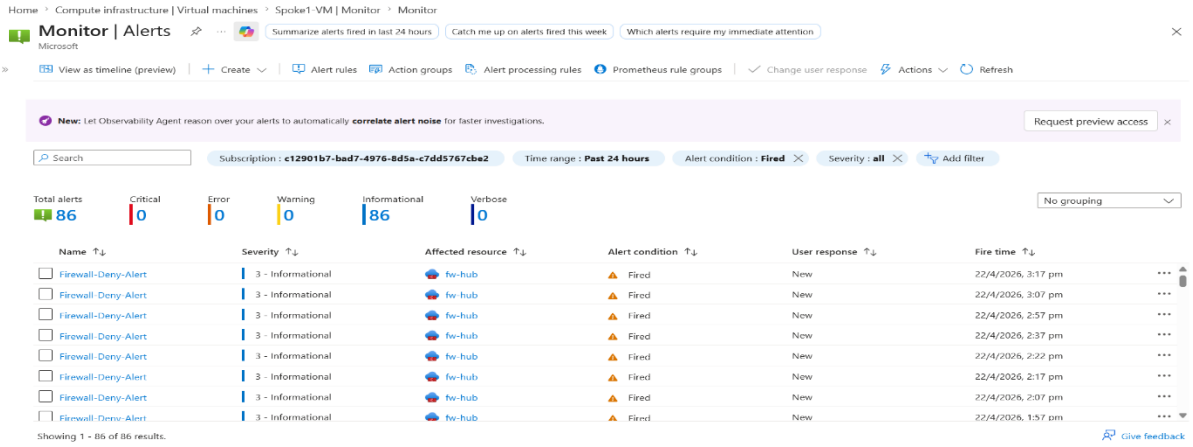
Action

Use same details as CPU alert.

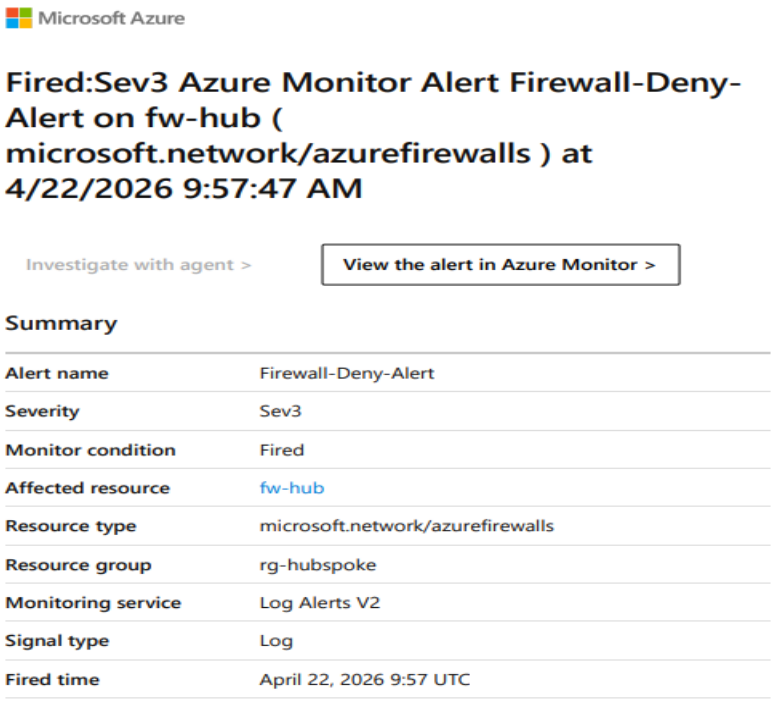
Details

- **Rule Name:** Firewall Alert

Click **Review + Create**



Same Firewall also gets **email alert**.



Alert ID	c8b584b9-59e4-da8d-278d-ca8b00e10024
Alert rule ID	https://portal.azure.com/#resource/subscriptions/c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7dd5767cbe2/resourceGroups/RG-HubSpoke/providers/microsoft.insights/scheduledqueryrules/Firewall-Deny-Alert

Dimensions.Dimension name1	_ResourceId
Dimensions.Dimension value1	/subscriptions/c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7dd5767cbe2/resourcegroups/rg-hubspoke/providers/microsoft.network/azurefirewalls/fw-hub
Filtered search results	View query results
Search results	View query results
Search query	AzureDiagnostics | where Category == "AzureFirewallNetworkRule" | take 5
Target resource types	['microsoft.network/azurefirewalls']
Time aggregation	Count
Operator	GreaterThan
Threshold	0
Metric value	3
Number of violations	1
Number of examined periods	1

Step 9.5: Metrics

Open:

Metrics → New Chart

Select Scope

Browse

- **Type:** VM
- **Region:** Central India

Scope

- Select **RG-HubSpoke-Project**

Refine Scope

- **Type:** VM
- **Region:** Central India

Click **Apply**

Select Metric

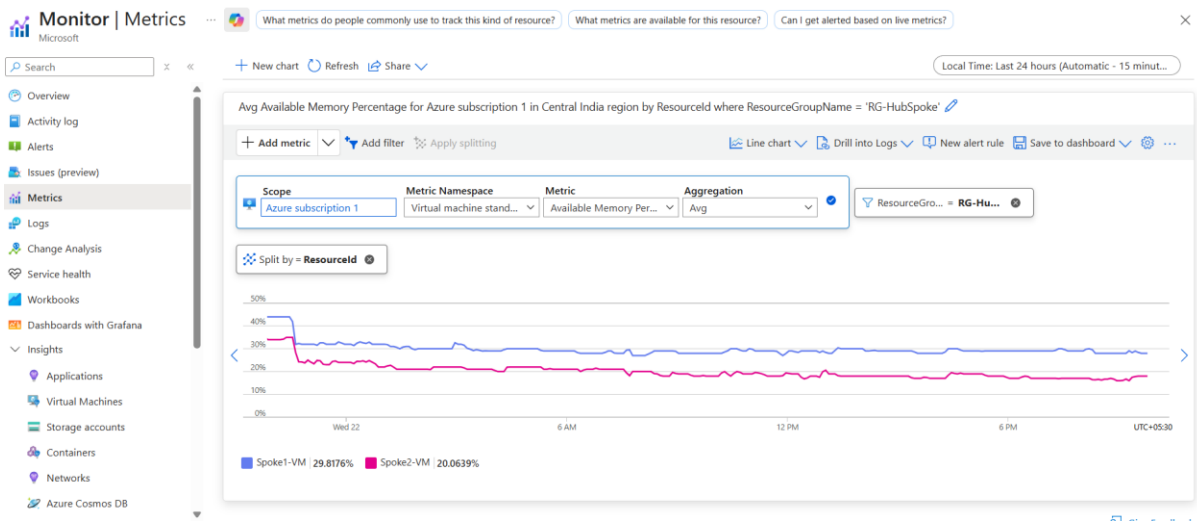
Examples:

- Available Memory Bytes
- Memory Percentage
- CPU Credits Consumed
- CPU Credits Remaining

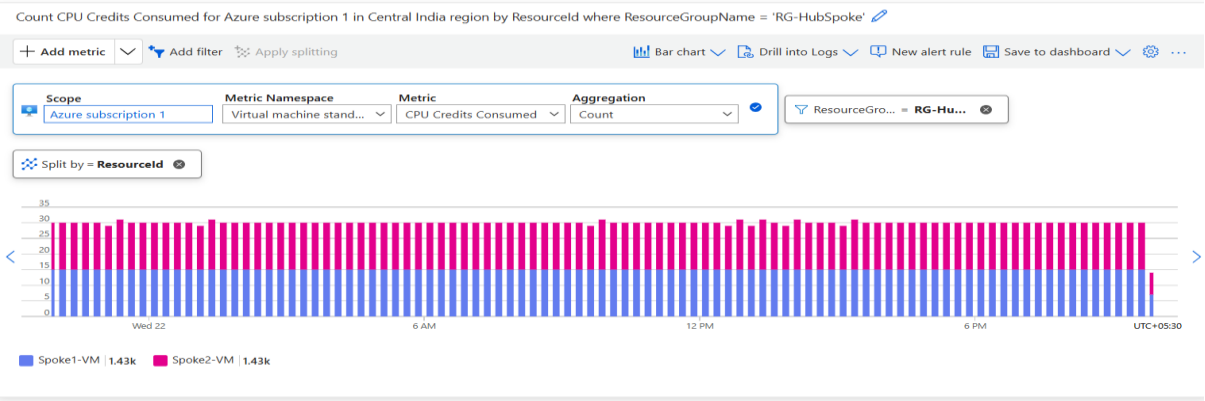
Chart Types Available

- Line Chart
- Bar Chart
- Scatter Chart
- Grid

Memory Percentage Metrics (Line Chart)



CPU Credits Consumed (Bar Chart)



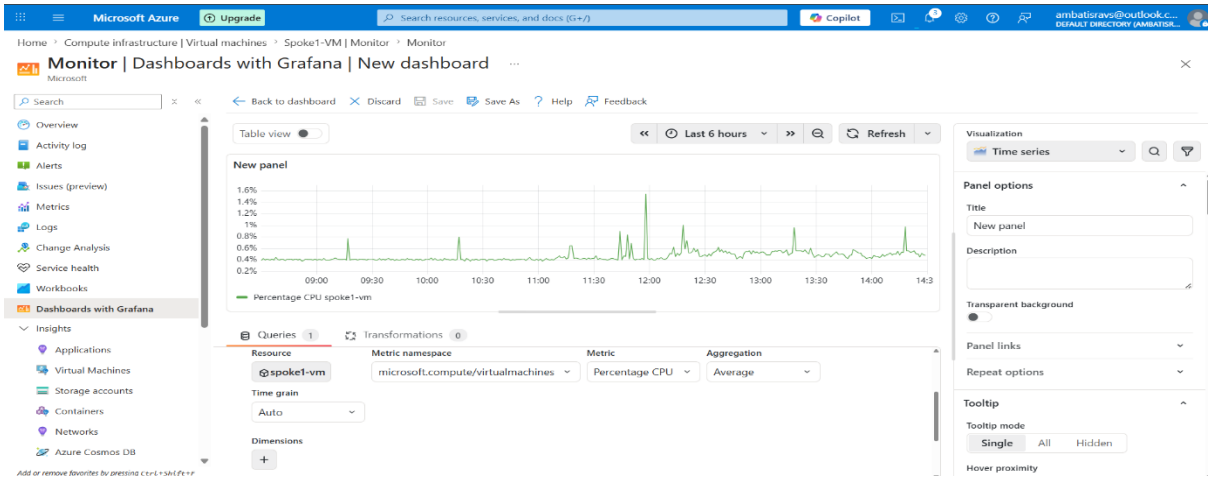
Step 9.6: Dashboard

Dashboard with Grafana

- Add Visualization

Data Source

- **Resource:** Spoke1-VM
- **Metric Namespace:** (not specified)
- **Metric:** Percentage CPU
- **Aggregation:** Average



In Spoke1-VM (CPU Load Testing)

yes > /dev/null &
yes > /dev/null &
yes > /dev/null &

```
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ yes > /dev/null &
[1] 38819
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ yes > /dev/null &
[2] 38820
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$ yes > /dev/null &
[3] 38821
mokesh@Spoke1-VM:~$
```

Use to create CPU spike/load for testing.

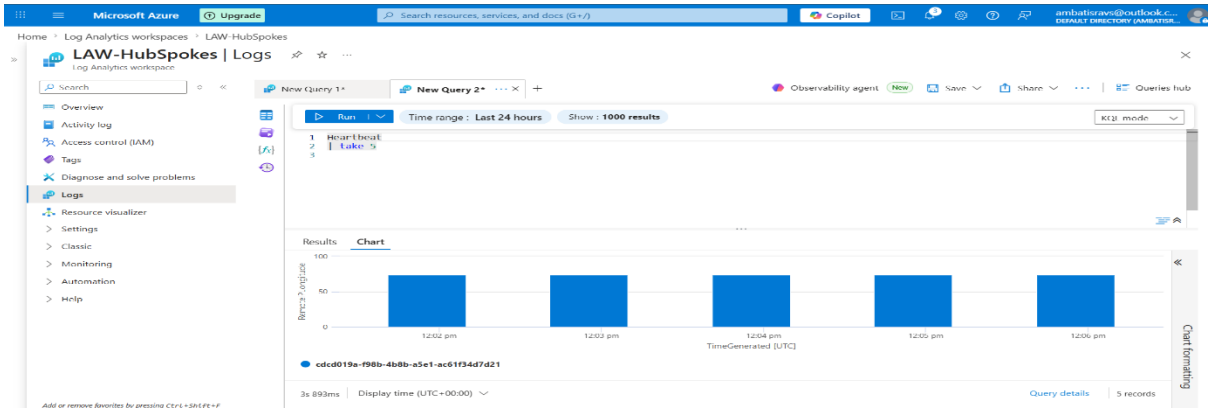
Stop CPU Load

killall bash Used to stop/delete spike load.

Logs Queries

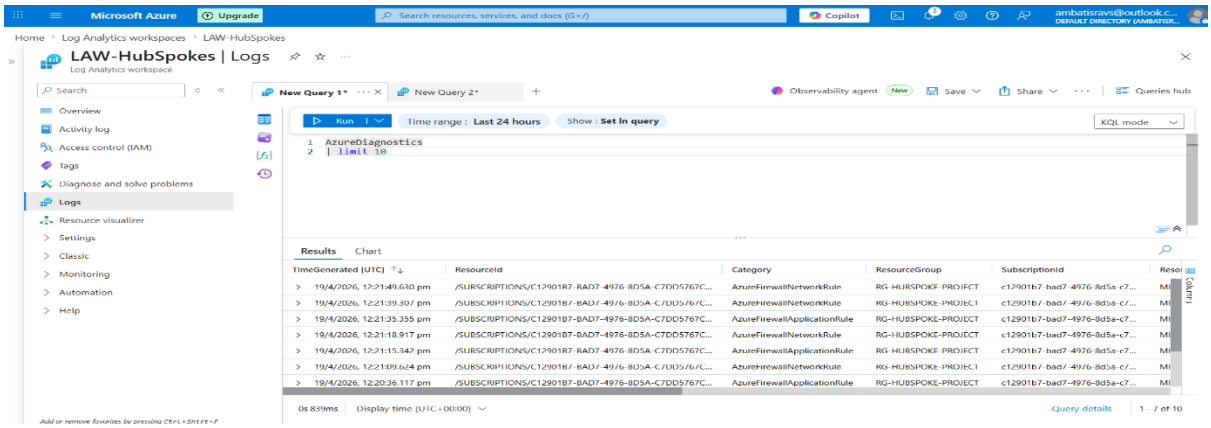
1. Heartbeat

Heartbeat
| take 5



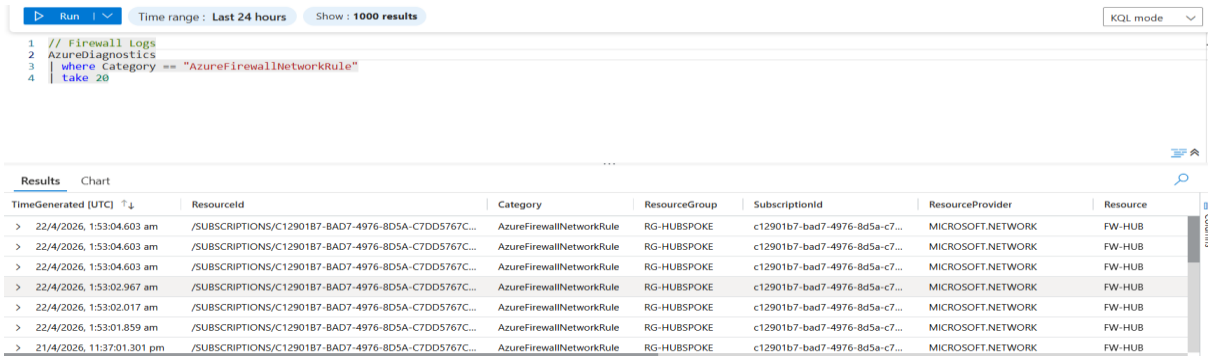
2. Azure Diagnostics

AzureDiagnostics
| limit 10



3. Show Firewall Logs

AzureDiagnostics
| where Category == "AzureFirewallNetworkRule"
| take 20



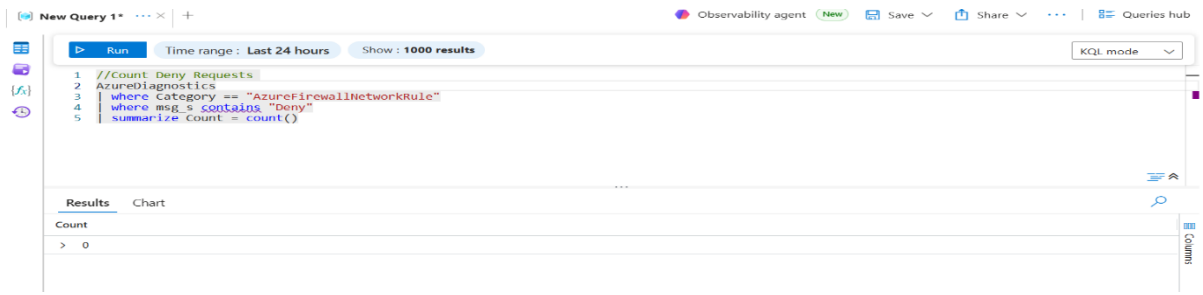
TimeGenerated [UTC]	ResourceId	Category	ResourceGroup	SubscriptionId	ResourceProvider	Resource
22/4/2026, 1:53:04.603 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
22/4/2026, 1:53:04.603 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
22/4/2026, 1:53:04.603 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
22/4/2026, 1:53:02.967 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
22/4/2026, 1:53:02.017 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
22/4/2026, 1:53:01.859 am	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB
21/4/2026, 11:37:01.301 pm	/SUBSCRIPTIONS/C12901B7-BAD7-4976-8D5A-C7DD5767C...	AzureFirewallNetworkRule	RG-HUBSPOKE	c12901b7-bad7-4976-8d5a-c7...	MICROSOFT.NETWORK	FW-HUB

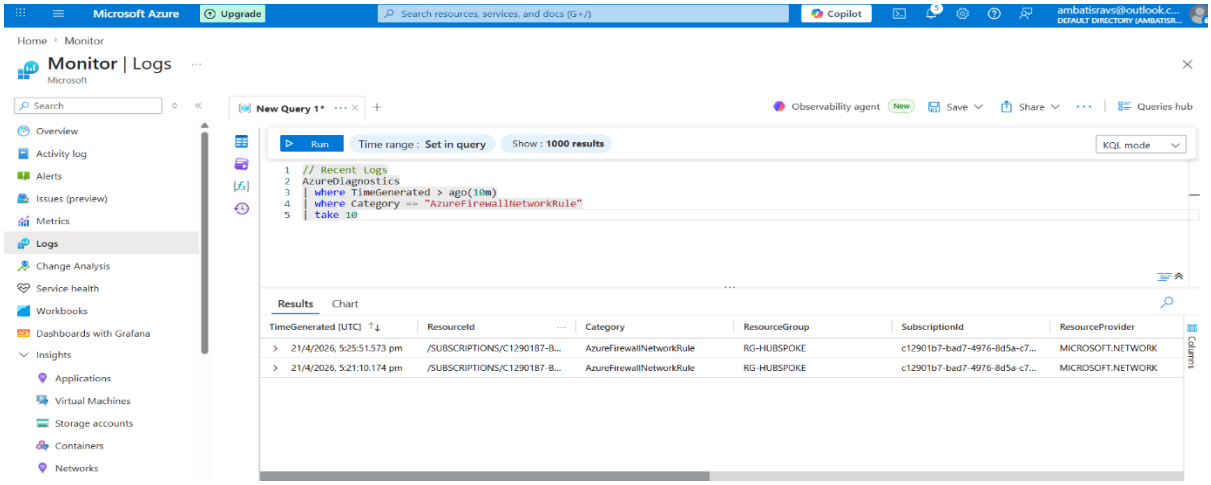
4. Count Deny Requests

```
AzureDiagnostics
| where Category == "AzureFirewallNetworkRule"
| where msg_s contains "Deny"
| summarize Count = count()
```

Output / Result

0



5. Recent Logs

```
AzureDiagnostics
| where TimeGenerated > ago(10m)
| where Category == "AzureFirewallNetworkRule"
| take 10
```